“They don’t let you in the shelters?” she said, alarmed.

“The things I’ve seen are inhumane.”

“Can you ask for a transfer?” she asked gently.

“It doesn’t work like that.” He shook his head.

But he couldn’t stay here helpless, a sitting duck for the bombers. Léa was convinced Berlin would continue to be hit, maybe levelled, and all the preparations seemed to indicate that was what they expected. Rose’s thoughts jumped to André’s poor mother—she imagined losing first a husband and the possibility of then losing a son in Germany would shatter her. Then her own feelings surfaced. André was the only man she’d ever kissed and the ache of possibly losing him was overwhelming. She couldn’t abandon him. Her mind raced for some way to get him out of here.

“Has any foreign worker been transferred out of Tempelhof?”

“There was a fellow from Lyon. He had some special skill, and they sent him to a factory in Hamburg.”

“So, it’s possible.”

“Forget it. I’m glad you came. Maybe we won’t see each other again,” he said, his voice raw.

“No,” she said. “You’ll make it through this war—I know you will.”

He waved a hand in the air, trying to look unconcerned, but his jaw tightened. Rose leaned forward, refusing to let it drop. Her mind spun to the one person who had the influence to help André. “There’s someone in Glashütte who might be able to help.”

“He’d have to be powerful to arrange for the transfer of a foreign worker.”

“He’s the Gestapo officer overseeing security for the foreign workers.”

André’s eyes went wide. “How do you know him?”

“We met by chance on a day when he was grieving the death of his brother. We’ve developed a relationship of sorts.” She told him about the sick bay, Léa typing Josef’s reports and how she delivered them to the Gestapo office every night. “I try to use my contact with him to get extra items like food vouchers or cash. The Eastern and Russian women’s rations are nearly at starvation levels.”

He looked at her for several seconds. “Does Léa know about this?”

“She encouraged me to engage with him.”

“You’re putting yourself in danger.”